DAY 24 — AI FOR MARKETING & CONTENT CREATION

Pixlr for Marketing: Interface Setup, Photo Editing, Layering & Ad Assembly

Core Focus: Step-by-Step Image Optimization and Social Ad Production

Target Audience: Intermediate Trainees

Primary Tools: Pixlr Express, Pixlr E, AI Auto-Enhance, ChatGPT

Key Outcome: Master browser-based image corrections, layer hierarchies, and promotional ad export standards.

Module 1: Pixlr Setup & Interface

- Pixlr Express vs Pixlr E
- Canvas dimensions & workspace setup
- Tool panels & file import

Module 2: Technical Image Corrections

- 1:1 Aspect ratio cropping
- Exposure, contrast & vibrance tuning
- Edge sharpening & AI auto-enhance

Module 3: Layer Architecture & Framing

- Multi-layer asset stacking order
- Framing & negative space allocation
- Graphic element integration

Module 4: Typography & Ad Export

- Direct-response text hierarchy
- Drop shadow legibility controls
- CTA buttons & final export standards

Core Technical Context:

- Pixlr: Browser-based raster photo editor with built-in AI tools.
- Pixlr Express: Template-driven quick adjustments.
- Pixlr E: Full-featured multi-layer professional editor.
- Workspace Panels: Toolbar (Left), Canvas (Center), Layer Stack (Right).

Step-by-Step Execution:

Step 1: Open Pixlr.com and launch Pixlr E.

Step 2: Click "Create New" and input 1080 x 1080 px canvas.

Step 3: Name the project file "Social_Promo_Master".

Step 4: Drag and drop product image file onto canvas.

Prompt: "Provide 3 modern layout concepts for an e-commerce social media square ad creative."

Image Adjustment Principles:

- Cropping: Removes background clutter; centers product visual.
- Exposure & Contrast: Distinguishes product from ambient lighting.
- Vibrance: Boosts muted tones without oversaturating.
- Sharpening: Enhances product edge clarity for mobile screens.

Step-by-Step Execution:

Step 1: Select Crop Tool (C) and lock aspect ratio to 1:1.

Step 2: Navigate to Adjustment > Auto Pop for baseline correction.

Step 3: Go to Adjustment > Color and set Vibrance to +15.

Step 4: Go to Adjustment > Exposure and set Contrast to +10.

Step 5: Apply Filter > Details > Sharpen (Radius: 2.0).

Prompt: "List exact tonal adjustment benchmarks for crisp e-commerce product photos."

Layer Stacking Hierarchy:

- Layer 1 (Bottom): Solid or gradient background fill.
- Layer 2 (Middle): Clean, color-corrected product subject.
- Layer 3 (Overlay): Promo badge and shape elements.
- Layer 4 (Top): High-contrast headline and CTA text.
- Rule: Keep 40% clean area for text to prevent visual clutter.

Step-by-Step Execution:

Step 1: Add empty layer below product and fill with dark blue.

Step 2: Position edited product image in lower-right canvas area.

Step 3: Click Layer > Duplicate to create a product shadow layer.

Step 4: Use Element Tool to draw a circular discount badge.

Prompt: "Generate a 3-part copy structure (Hook, Benefit, CTA) for a premium product ad."

Typography & Conversion Standards:

- Headline: 3 to 5 words, bold sans-serif font, 48pt.
- Value Offer: Specific promotion (e.g., 25% Off Weekend Sale).
- CTA Shape: High-contrast rounded rectangle button.
- Shadow Settings: Black drop shadow at 60% opacity for legibility.
- Export Specs: PNG/JPG at 1080x1080 px, file size under 1MB.

Step-by-Step Execution:

Step 1: Select Text Tool (T) and add headline "ELEVATE YOUR WORK".

Step 2: In Text Options, enable Shadow: Opacity 60%, Blur 4.

Step 3: Draw rounded rectangle behind "SHOP NOW" text button.

Step 4: Navigate to File > Save > PNG and download file.

Prompt: "Write 3 direct-response headline variations for a limited-time technology sale."

Lab Brief: "Smart Fitness Tracker Ad"

- Target Canvas: 1080 x 1080 px (Square Post).
- Raw Assets: 1 watch photo + 1 logo mark.
- Target Audience: Active working professionals.
- Core Offer: 20% Discount with coupon code.

Execution Checklist:

Step 1: Crop and center watch photo to 1:1 ratio.

Step 2: Apply +10 Contrast, +15 Vibrance, +2 Sharpness.

Step 3: Insert headline "TRACK YOUR PEAK PERFORMANCE".

Step 4: Add discount badge "20% OFF — TODAY ONLY".

Step 5: Insert high-contrast CTA button "CLAIM OFFER".

Step 6: Export final file as high-quality PNG.

5-Point Quality Audit Checklist:

1. Clarity: Product is sharp with no pixelation.
2. Contrast: Text is readable within 2 seconds.
3. Alignment: Balanced margins and clear visual center.
4. Hierarchy: Visual flows: Product $\rightarrow$ Offer $\rightarrow$ CTA.
5. File Size: Optimized under 1MB for fast loading.

Key Takeaways:

- Pixlr delivers rapid photo correction and ad graphic assembly.
- Fixed layer stacks prevent overlapping errors.
- Contrast and drop shadows guarantee text legibility.

Exit Ticket:

1. What tool locks 1:1 image cropping in Pixlr?
2. What is the correct layer order for text vs background?